

Transcript

(0:00-1:00) **Introduction**

"Good morning. For my project, I interviewed 'Kelsey,' a 26-year-old Lecturer here at Baylor. Kelsey's life is a study in Social Mobility, but also in how we guard the boundaries of our social class. Growing up in Pearland, her parents pushed her to 'explore all options'—a classic example of Concerted Cultivation. My focus today is on how Kelsey's dating life isn't just about her feelings; it's a mechanism that perpetuates Social Stratification."

(1:00-2:30) **The Degree as a Barrier**

"Kelsey was raised with the lesson that 'education can't be taken away from you'. She treats her degrees as Institutionalized Cultural Capital—a permanent safety net. Because of this, Kelsey practices strict Educational Endogamy. She refuses to date anyone below her schooling level, explicitly seeking partners 'at that level or above me'. This choice prevents class dilution. By only marrying or dating within her academic stratum, she ensures that class advantages remain concentrated, and this is a process referred to as Social Closure."

(2:30-4:00) **Vibes, Classes, and Conflict**

"When Kelsey looks for what she calls 'vibes,' she is actually checking for a shared Managerial approach to life. Sociologist Jessi Streib (2013) found that middle-class origin individuals, like Kelsey, plan and oversee their lives, while those from working-class origins often 'go with the flow'. Kelsey's relationship with an athlete ex-boyfriend failed precisely because of this gap. His family didn't value her doctoral aspirations, and he eventually pressured her to drop out and stay home. As Streib notes, 'merged lives do not lead to merged ideas of how to lead them'. This Cultural Conflict acted as a deterrent, pushing Kelsey back toward her own class lane."

(4:00-5:00) **Conclusion**

"Ultimately, Kelsey's story shows us that dating is the silent architect of inequality. By filtering for shared Cultural Capital and avoiding the 'cost' of class conflict, we reproduce the same social hierarchies we were born into. Kelsey's romantic choices aren't just personal; they are the unwritten rules that keep social classes separate and unequal. Thanks for listening."